

Thanika Puhazholi

thanika@outlook.com | Bellevue, WA | [linkedin.com/in/thanikapuhazholi](https://www.linkedin.com/in/thanikapuhazholi)

Summary

First-year Computer Science student at the UW (Direct Admit) blending software engineering rigor with a product-driven mindset. Experienced in building applied AI solutions, from predictive aerospace models to NLP-powered B2B outreach systems. Seeking a software engineering or product management internship to turn technical skills into high-impact, user-centric products.

Education

University of Washington, Seattle, WA

Expected: June 2030

- B.S. in Computer Science, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering (Direct Admission)

Newport High School, Bellevue, WA | High School Diploma

Graduated: June 2026

- **GPA:** 3.93/4.0 (unweighted), **SAT:** 1540/1600
- **Courses:** AP Comp Sci A (5/5), AP Comp Sci Principles (5/5), AP Calculus AB & BC (5/5), AP Statistics (5/5)

Technical Skills

- **Languages:** Python, Java
- **Libraries/Frameworks:** TensorFlow, Keras, Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-learn
- **Technologies:** ML (Regression, Classification, Neural Networks), NLP, GPT Model Optimization, Data Visualization, Git, Zapier

Professional & Research Experience

AI Researcher | Cambridge Center for International Research

Summer 2025

- Selected from 500+ applicants for an elite research program mentored by Harvard Professor Dr. Hannah Rana
- Built a predictive model using Kennedy Space Center launch datasets to forecast launch viability based on windshear, lightning, and rainfall data. Conducted advanced data analysis and model validation

AI Developer Intern, ML Division | Elite Performance Partners

Summer 2025

- Engineered ML tools and optimized GPT models to reduce hallucinations and improve source-based accuracy
- Built automated client engagement and communication workflows using Zapier, boosting operational efficiency

AI Product Manager Intern | Venu.AI

Sep - Nov 2024

- Led B2B outreach using AI-driven targeting and built an NLP-powered email system
- Created strategic content and collaborated with cross-functional teams to enhance client engagement

AI Programmer, AI Scholars Program | Inspirit AI

Fall 2023

- Developed a hybrid ML model for pneumonia detection by integrating classification and regression algorithms with neural networks to analyze X-ray images
- Awarded a certificate of excellence for contributions and technical skills

Leadership & Extracurricular Activities

Vice President & Lead Mechanical Engineer | Rocketry Club, Newport High School

Sep 2023 - Jun 2026

- Led team to a top-20 national finish (out of 1,000+ teams) at the 2024 American Rocketry Challenge
- Applied AI to assess weather conditions and flight stability, optimizing rocket altitude and recovery
- Mentored 90+ members

Co-Founder & Vice President | Artificial Intelligence Club, Newport High School

Sep 2023 - Jun 2026

- Co-founded club to explore real-world AI applications and ethics; grew membership to over 30 students
- Led outreach initiatives, organized speaker events, and built interactive AI demos for 50+ middle schoolers

Awards & Activities

- **Awards:** American Rocketry Challenge National Finalist, Top 20 (2024); DECA Area Competition Honorable Mention, Top 10 Presenter (2024); Student of the Month, Newport High School (2024)
- **National Honor Society:** 70+ community service hours; organized donation drives and coordinated the annual Ski Swap
- **Arts:** Ballet instructor (mentored 30+ young dancers) and lead performer, Emerald Ballet Theatre; Bharatanatyam dancer (10+ years) and social media lead, Kala Alaya School of Dance; vocalist and pianist